

Glasgow, up close

From an immigration officer recognising *Sportstar* to Glasgow's volunteers, Tejaswin Shankar and **unforgettable encounters**, a reporter's diary from the Commonwealth Games.

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Lowering his spectacles, the immigration officer at Chennai Airport studied my passport and ticket before asking, "What is your date of birth?" and "Where are you going?"

When I told him I was heading to Glasgow for the Commonwealth Games, the officer, who had worn a

staid expression until then, suddenly lit up.

"*Sportstar* magazine... and those lovely posters! Wish you all the best, Sir," he said, stamping my passport.

Kindness of strangers

Glaswegians are, by nature, gentle, unfailingly polite and remarkably helpful. Even though the

Commonwealth Games volunteers had been trained to be professional, their warmth shone through in every interaction. Whether answering questions about competition schedules or giving directions to venues, they responded with patience, courtesy and a smile. Not once did they show signs of fatigue or irritation.

